

Chau (Clara) T. N. Tran

Master of Arts in Linguistics, McGill University

Montréal, QC, Canada

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Last updated: May 2026

Research Interests

Second language acquisition of syntactic phenomena; experimental methods in linguistics; Vietnamese clause structure and the left periphery; prosody and sentence processing.

Education

McGill University, Montréal, QC *08/2024 – 06/2026*

Master of Arts (Non-Thesis) in Linguistics; CGPA: 3.95/4.0

MA Research Paper: *Exhaustivity without strong uniqueness: Specificational and cleft-like là in Vietnamese*

Graduate coursework: Syntax 3–4; Semantics 3–4; Phonology 3; Computational Research on Language; Experimental Linguistics: Methods (Regression Modeling for Linguistic Data)

Saint Mary's University, Halifax, NS *01/2020 – 01/2024*

Bachelor of Arts (Honours) in Linguistics; Minor in Psychology

CGPA: 4.21/4.30; Dean's List 2020–2021, 2021–2022

The Language Centre, Saint Mary's University, Halifax, NS *07/2021*

Certificate in Teaching English to Speakers of Other Languages (CELTA)

Awards & Scholarships

Fonds de recherche du Québec (FRQ) – Master's Research Scholarship *2025 – 2026*

Graduate Excellence Award, McGill University *2024 – 2025*

Linguistics Book Prize, Saint Mary's University *2024*

Academic Award of Excellence, Saint Mary's University *2024*

SSHRC Explore Undergraduate Summer Research Award *2022*

Saint Mary's University.

Work Experience

Research Assistant, Program in Linguistics

Saint Mary's University, Halifax, NS

03/2023 – 04/2023

Supervisor: Dr. Natália B. Guzzo

- Recruited participants and collected data for an experiment in linguistics;

- Assisted with data management and preliminary organization for analysis.

Research Assistant, Department for the Study of Religion

Saint Mary's University, Halifax, NS

11/2021 – 04/2023

Supervisor: Dr. Alec Soucy

- Assisted with Vietnamese language materials for research;
- Performed administrative and organizational tasks related to the project.

SSHRC Explore Undergraduate Summer Research Assistant, Program in Linguistics

Saint Mary's University, Halifax, NS

05/2022 – 08/2022

Supervisor: Dr. Daniel Hall

- Digitized a database of utterances in the Mende language;
- Identified and coded sound patterns in the database for phonological analysis.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Department of Linguistics

McGill University, Montréal, QC

08/2025 – 05/2026

LING 201 Introduction to Linguistics

(Fall 2025, Instructor: Alex Zhai; Winter 2026, Instructor: Martina Martinović)

- Taught weekly conference sections to review lecture material and practice problem sets;
- Graded assignments and exams; provided feedback on students' work.

Linguistics Tutor, Program in Linguistics

Saint Mary's University, Halifax, NS

09/2022 – 04/2023; 09/2023 – 12/2023

- Assisted students with phonetics/phonology problem sets, syntax analysis, and other core theoretical concepts.

Teaching Assistant, Saint Mary's University

Halifax, NS

09/2021 – 04/2022

ASNT 1105 Introduction to Chinese Culture (Fall 2021, Instructor: Ping Lu)

- Graded quizzes and supported online course delivery (Zoom).

ANTH 1290 Introduction to Language and Society (Winter 2022, Instructor: Eric Henry)

- Communicated with students, graded written assignments, and held review sessions before each exam.

CELTA Teaching Practice

07/2021

- Completed 6 hours of observed teaching practice with mixed-nationality groups from Elementary to Upper-Intermediate levels;
- Taught lessons targeting reading, listening, speaking, writing, grammar, lexis, and phonology.

Conference Presentation

Tran, C. and Natália B. Guzzo. (2025). *Relative Clause Attachment by L1 Vietnamese–L2 English Bilinguals: Effects of Prosody* [manuscript in preparation]. Paper presented at the Canadian Linguistic Association (CLA) Annual Meeting, McGill University, Montréal, QC, June 3–5.

Skills

Research & Technical

- Academic literature review and research design;
- R programming for statistical analysis and data visualization;
- L^AT_EX for academic writing and document preparation;
- Praat for acoustic analysis, annotation, and experiment design.

Teaching & Communication

- ESL teaching (CELTA-certified);
- Instruction and lesson planning for undergraduate linguistics courses;
- Academic writing and oral presentation.

Languages

Vietnamese (native); English (advanced; IELTS 7.0 in 01/2018); Mandarin Chinese (intermediate); French (basic–intermediate; DELF B1 certificate in 01/2020); German (beginner).